

GODS OF ASGARD

Immortals who rule the dimension of Asgard

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FACTFILE

KEY ASGARDIANS

ODIN
(Monarch of Asgard) The most powerful god, possessing vast magical abilities. He can enchant objects or living beings, project energy bolts, and open gateways between dimensions. He also commands the life energies of all Asgardians, which he can absorb at will.

THOR
(God of Thunder) Asgard's finest warrior; exceptionally skilled in hand-to-hand combat, swordsmanship, and hammer-throwing.

BALDER
(God of Light) Thor's closest friend; almost invulnerable; skilled in hand-to-hand combat, swordsmanship, and horsemanship.

HELA
(Goddess of Death) Ruler of the underworlds of Hel and Niflheim; holds the power of life and death over the gods; can levitate and travel in astral form; touch is fatal to mortals.

LOKI
(God of Evil) Great magical abilities; can shapeshift into any animal, god, or giant; can plant hypnotic suggestions into others' minds.

HERMOD
(God of Speed) Fastest of all Asgardians.

HODER
(God of Winter) Has psychic abilities that allow him to see into the future.

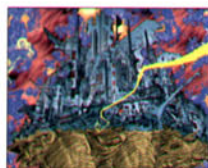
VALKYRIE
Brunnhilde the Valkyrie can see a "deathglow" around a person about to die. She can transport herself (and a dead or dying person) from one dimension to another.

HEIMDALL
Guardian of the Rainbow Bridge has extremely acute senses. He can focus on, or block out, any specific sensory information.

VOLLA
Prophetess who can see alternate futures.

BASE
The Otherdimensional Realm of Asgard

FIRST APPEARANCE
Journey into Mystery #85, (October 1962)



The otherdimensional planetary body known as Asgard.

The Gods of Asgard are a powerful race of beings who live in a dimension called Asgard, a small, otherdimensional planetary body whose laws of physics are different from the planets we know in the Earthly realm. Asgard is also home to five

other races—Giants, Dwarves, Elves, Trolls, and Demons. The Gods of Asgard are the most human-looking and powerful of the six races of Asgard.

NINE WORLDS

All Asgardian refer to the known universe as the "Nine Worlds of Asgard." Four of those worlds—Asgard, home of the gods; Vanaheim, home of the Asgardians' sister race called the Vanir; Nidavellir, home of the Dwarves; and Alfheim, home of the Light Elves—actually share the planetary body on which Asgard is located.

The other five worlds exist in separate dimensions connected by an unknown number of interdimensional nexuses. They are Midgard, the Asgardian name for Earth, home of humanity; Jotunheim, home of the giants; Svartalfheim, home of the dark

elves; Hel, land of the dead and it's adjunct world Niflheim, the frozen realm of the dishonored dead; and Muspelheim, land of the fire demons and home to Surtur, the Gods of Asgard's most deadly enemy.

RAINBOW BRIDGE

The origin of the Gods of Asgard is not clearly known, but it believed that unlike the other races of the realm, the gods are not native to Asgard. Legend has it that they were born on Earth, but moved to Asgard at some time in the far distant past. The Rainbow Bridge, also known as Bifrost—one of the interdimensional nexuses—connects Asgard to Earth.

Although they look like humans, the Gods of Asgard possess superhuman physical abilities. They are extremely long-lived (although not immortal, unlike their Olympian counterparts) and age at an extremely slow pace once they reach adulthood.

Their skin and bones are three times as dense as that of a human and are invulnerable, to a degree, to physical attack. They possess great strength (able to lift 30 tons) and, due to their density, weigh far more than humans of comparable size. The Gods of Asgard are immune to all diseases found on Earth and their metabolism gives them superhuman endurance while performing physical activities.

All Asgardians are born with the potential to use and control mystical energies, although only a few (such as LOKI) have developed this power to any significant degree.



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1 Enchantress 2 Sif 3 Balder the Brave
4 Hela, Goddess of Death 5 Hermod, God of Speed
6 Loki 7 Thor 8 Heimdall, Guardian of the Rainbow Bridge 9 Thunderstrike 10 Odin 11 Karnilla, the Nom Queen 12 Kurse 13 Frigga 14 Fandral the Dashing 15 Volstagg the Enormous 16 Hogun the Grim 17 Thor Girl 18 Malekith 19 Surtur 20 Ulrik, the Unstoppable Rock Troll

ESSENTIAL STORYLINES

• *The Mighty Thor* Vol. 2 #80-85 The Ragnarok (Doom of the Gods) Saga. Loki and his followers unleash an attack on Asgard intended to destroy the home of the gods and all its inhabitants. Thor's hammer Mjolnir is shattered during the battle that follows.
• *The Mighty Thor* #418 The fire demon Surtur possesses Odin and gains control of Asgard.



The Storm Giants, sworn enemies of the Gods, eat and drink their fill in Jotunheim, their Asgardian home. Odin challenged Thor and Loki (in foreground) to return the Golden apples of Iduna to the Storm Giants.

prove his valor. When Thor was sixteen, Odin finally presented him with the mighty hammer, and Thor became Asgard's greatest warrior.

Odin adopted Loki, who quickly turned to sorcery and earned the nickname, "God of Mischief." Jealous of Thor, Loki vowed to destroy him. Loki launched Ragnarok but Thor broke the cycle and stopped the war. The gods disappeared but later reappeared in mortal guises. Thor

brought them to a reborn Asgard, which now hovers over the plains of Oklahoma.

MT, MF

Ymir, King of the Ice Giants

ODIN, THOR, AND LOKI

Odin, also called All-Father, is the leader of the Gods of Asgard. Odin is the grandson of Buri, the first of the Asgardians. He is the son of the God Bor and Bestia, of the race of frost giants.

For many ages, Odin has ruled Asgard wisely and effectively. Odin wields the enchanted, three-pronged spear Gungnir ("The Spear of Heaven"), which returns to his hand when thrown, and he travels through space in Skipbladnir, a Viking-style longboat with enchanted sails and oars.

SON OF ODIN

Although Odin made the Asgardian Goddess Frigga his queen, he desired a son that would combine the power of Asgard and Earth, and so he mated with GAEA, the patron Goddess of Earth, who bore him THOR, the God of Thunder, Odin's favorite son. However, from the time Thor was an infant, he was raised in Asgard by Frigga, whom he believed to be his mother.

When Thor was eight, Odin sent him to

Nidavellir, land of the Dwarves, to ask them to create treasures for Asgard's rulers. Among the objects they created was the hammer Mjolnir, forged of the mystical metal uru. Odin enchanted the hammer so that only one worthy of wielding such a powerful weapon could lift it. He hoped that Thor would one day be that one.

HEROIC DEEDS

For the next eight years Thor strove to become worthy enough to possess Mjolnir, doing many heroic deeds to

In the early days of Asgard, the rampaging Ice Giants attempted to bring frost, desolation and eternal night to the land of the gods. They were defeated by Odin and his warriors.



The Fantastic Four cross Bifrost, the Rainbow Bridge to Asgard, which is guarded by Heimdall, Sentry of Asgard.

